



1ST WEEK: **DAY 2**

Settling in

YOUR BABY TODAY

Newborn babies sleep around 16 hours a day, although some sleep for most of the first few days while others seem awake and fretful. If your baby is very sleepy, you may need to wake them for feedings, which should be at least every four hours.

“You may be feeling anxious about your new responsibilities, but be reassured by the support network around you.”

Your ob-gyn will visit in the hospital today. They will ask how you are managing and check that you have emergency contact numbers. You may be asked to watch short films or read brochures about the risks of Shaken Baby Syndrome and/or Sudden Infant Death Syndrome. A pediatrician will also examine your baby in the hospital today.

It's important that you eat a healthy diet and rest during the day whenever possible. [Kegel exercises](#) are vital to strengthen your muscles. If you were given painkillers or anti-inflammatory medicine, take these as necessary. If you get visitors, make sure they wash their hands before touching the baby.

Do I need to clean the cord stump before it drops off? Your baby's cord stump, which is the end of the umbilical cord, will shrivel up and fall off naturally around 7–10 days after the birth. Many parents feel uneasy about touching the stump and are unsure whether or not to clean it. Some pediatricians recommend swabbing it regularly with rubbing alcohol, but others say to leave it alone. However, if it does become dirty, clean with soap and water and dry well. If the cord stump or the surrounding area are sticky, inflamed, or smelly, contact your doctor for advice. It's important to keep the cord stump dry. Exposing it to air at times helps avoid the risk of infection.

While you're in the hospital, you may get lots of visitors. And while it's fun to show off your beautiful baby to friends and family, make sure that you take time to sleep, because once you bring your baby home, you won't have much opportunity to sleep. Many hospitals let you decide whether the baby will sleep in the room with you at night or in the nursery. There's no wrong decision; do what feels best for you and your baby.

STITCHES AND HEMORRHOIDS

You can take an analgesic, but the following can also increase comfort:

- When you urinate, pour warm water over the area to ease stinging.